

CONTEXT FOR ASTRA

You are my German tutor. I am Kevin, Italian, level A2-B1. My lessons are taught in English by a native German speaker (Stefanie). Today we are reviewing: **Holiday Small Talk & Comparisons**

Sections covered: 27. Speaking: aussehen, Halb-/Vollpension, ziemlich günstig, Paket/Päckchen, distance expressions (bis zum, am nächsten, weiter als), langweilig/mir ist langweilig, ausprobieren/anprobieren/probieren zu, betrunken/sich betrinken, die Kontrolle verlieren, es schaffen, Streifen, Batterie aufladen

LESSON SUMMARY

Kevin describes his all-inclusive holiday in Tenerife with his mother and aunt. The lesson focused on natural conversational structures for describing locations, distances, and comparisons (weiter als, am nächsten). Key expressions covered: 'aussehen' (to look like), 'ziemlich günstig' (quite cheap), distance expressions with 'bis zum Strand', and 'es schaffen' (to manage/be able to). Vocabulary expanded around hotel amenities, drinking/partying contexts (sich betrinken, betrunken sein, die Kontrolle verlieren), and trying things out (ausprobieren vs. versuchen/probieren zu). Grammar included subordinate clauses with 'die...hat' structures and adjective endings in plural dative (mit den gelben Streifen). The lesson emphasized natural German phrasing over direct translations.

KEY VOCABULARY

- **aussehen** — to look like [A2]
- **ziemlich** — quite, fairly [B1]
- **günstig** — affordable, cheap (in standard German) [A2]
- **billig** — cheap (used more in Austria/Switzerland) [A2]
- **das Paket** — package [A2]
- **das Päckchen** — small package [A2]
- **die Vollpension** — full board [A2]
- **die Halbpension** — half board [A2]
- **All-inclusive** — all-inclusive [A2]
- **entfernt** — away, distant [B1]
- **die Entfernung** — distance [B1]
- **das Bett** — bed [A1]
- **der Pool** — pool [A2]
- **langweilig** — boring [A2]
- **ausprobieren** — to try out [B1]
- **anprobieren** — to try on (clothes) [A2]
- **der Hauptstrand** — main beach [A2]
- **die Jugendliche** — young people, teenagers [A2]
- **betrunken** — drunk [B1]
- **sich betrinken** — to get drunk [B1]

- **die Kontrolle** — control [B1]
- **schaffen** — to manage, to be able to [B1]
- **der Streifen** — stripe [B1]
- **die Batterie** — battery [A2]
- **aufladen** — to charge (battery) [B1]
- **besonders** — especially, particularly [B1]
- **die Hose** — trousers, pants [A1]
- **die Sangria** — sangria [A2]

GRAMMAR POINTS

Distance expressions with 'bis zu'

→ To express distance to a location, use 'Es sind [number] Meter bis zum/zur [place]'. 'Bis zu' means 'up to' and requires dative case. The preposition 'zu' governs the dative case and contracts with articles (zu + dem = zum, zu + der = zur).

e.g. Es sind nur 100 Meter bis zum Strand.

e.g. Es sind 5 Kilometer bis zur Stadt.

Comparative 'als' in comparisons

→ Use 'als' (than) for unequal comparisons with comparative adjectives in German. 'Als' introduces the comparative of superiority. The case after 'als' typically matches the case of what's being compared.

e.g. Die anderen Hotels sind weiter als mein Hotel.

e.g. Er ist größer als sein Bruder.

Subordinate clauses with relative pronouns

→ Relative clauses in German use pronouns (der/die/das) that agree with the gender and number of the noun they refer to. The case of the relative pronoun depends on its function within the relative clause. The conjugated verb moves to the end of the subordinate clause.

e.g. Die Hose, die gelbe Streifen hat, gefällt mir.

e.g. Der Mann, den ich gestern gesehen habe, ist mein Lehrer.

Adjective endings in dative plural

→ In dative plural, adjectives take the '-en' ending regardless of gender. The definite article is 'den' and plural nouns that don't already end in -n or -s add -n in the dative case.

e.g. Ich spiele mit den kleinen Kindern.

e.g. Er hilft den älteren Menschen.

'zu' placement in separable verb infinitives

→ With separable verbs in infinitive constructions requiring 'zu', the 'zu' is inserted between the separable prefix and the base verb, written as one word. Structure: prefix + zu + base verb stem (e.g., aufladen, anrufen, einkaufen).

e.g. Ich versuche, die Batterie aufzuladen.

e.g. Es ist wichtig, pünktlich anzukommen.

USEFUL PHRASES / REDEMittel

- **Mir ist langweilig** — I am bored (*Expresses being bored using dative construction (literally: 'It is boring to me'), more common than 'Ich bin gelangweilt'*)
- **den ganzen Tag** — the whole day (*Fixed expression using accusative case for time duration*)

- **Es sind nur 100 Meter bis zum Strand** — It's only 100 meters to the beach (*Natural way to express distance to a location*)
- **das komplette Paket** — the complete package (*Refers to all-inclusive deals or complete offers*)
- **die Kontrolle verlieren** — to lose control (*Describes losing self-control, often used for drunk behavior*)

EXERCISES TO GENERATE

1. FILL IN THE BLANK (5 sentences)

Use the key vocabulary above. Leave one word blank per sentence. Show the answer after a separator.

2. TRANSLATION DE → EN (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

3. TRANSLATION EN → DE (5 sentences)

Use vocabulary and grammar from this lesson.

4. DIALOGUE COMPLETION (2 short dialogues, 3-4 lines)

Leave one or two lines blank. Context: everyday situations using today's grammar (Distance expressions with 'bis zu').

5. FREE WRITING PROMPT

Ask me to write 3-5 sentences in German using at least 5 words from today's vocabulary.

6. GRAMMAR DRILL (5 sentences)

Focus on: Distance expressions with 'bis zu'. Show sentences with errors for me to correct.

INSTRUCTIONS

- Correct all my answers immediately with explanation in English
- Note recurring mistakes throughout the session
- Use only A2-B1 vocabulary unless I ask for more
- If I write something correct but unnatural, suggest a more native alternative
- Use 'die KI' not 'AI' when referring to artificial intelligence